FILM MAKING AND RADIO PODCASTING CD23731

REPORT

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BONAFIDE CERTIFICATE

Certified that this report titled "Film Making and Radio podcasting CD23731" is the bonafide work of SANJAY J (231701047) who carried out the work under my supervision. Certified further that to the best of my knowledge the work reported herein does not form part of any other thesis or dissertation on the basis of which a degree or award was conferred on an earlier occasion on this or any other candidate.

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CHAPTER 1
INTRODUCTION

Film making is a creative form of visual communication that combines storytelling, acting, cinematography, sound, lighting and editing to communicate an idea or experience to an audience. A short film presents a complete story within a limited duration, making it important to develop a clear concept and use every scene effectively. Radio podcasting, on the other hand, communicates stories through audio elements such as narration, dialogue, music, sound effects and silence. Both forms require creativity, planning and effective storytelling.

The project titled "THE CHILDHOOD FRIEND" is a short emotional drama film developed as part of the Film Making and Radio Podcasting course. The story begins with a simple and familiar situation in which Sanjay, a college student, is casually talking with his new college friend, Jai, about their semester marks. Their conversation is interrupted when Venkat, Sanjay's childhood friend, enters the room. Sanjay introduces the two, and all three quickly settle into an easy, friendly conversation about academics and their plans to study together.

As the story develops, a subtle imbalance appears. When Venkat suggests that the friends go out to eat, Sanjay hesitates, but the moment Jai makes the same suggestion, Sanjay agrees immediately, leaving Venkat behind. Soon afterward, Sanjay realises he has missed his college bus and urgently needs a way to get to class. Jai, his new friend, is unable to help because he is already committed elsewhere. Venkat, despite having just been overlooked, steps forward without hesitation and offers to drop Sanjay to college. This moment of quiet loyalty makes Sanjay reflect on how he treated his oldest friend, and he apologises. The film closes with Sanjay recognising that new friendships are welcome, but the value of an old friend must never be forgotten.

The project is designed not only as a visual short film but also as a story that can be adapted into a radio podcast. The visual elements of the film, particularly the characters' expressions and body language, can be replaced by narration, voice acting, sound effects and background music in the podcast version.

CHAPTER 2
PROJECT OVERVIEW

The main idea of THE CHILDHOOD FRIEND is to transform an ordinary, everyday college situation into a quiet, emotionally resonant lesson about loyalty and friendship. The first part of the film intentionally appears light and realistic. The audience sees three college friends talking casually about studies and assumes the story is simply about student life. This familiar setting helps the audience connect with the characters.

As the story progresses, small, almost unnoticeable choices by Sanjay begin to create emotional distance between him and Venkat. The audience senses this shift before Sanjay himself does. The missed-bus situation introduces a moment of real consequence, testing which friendship holds up when it is actually needed. The final scene resolves this tension and leaves the audience with a simple, relatable message about not taking old friends for granted.

The film uses a single main location, a small number of characters and easily available objects such as a television, a sofa and a mobile phone. This makes the project practical to produce while still allowing different film-making techniques to be demonstrated.

CHAPTER 3
TITLE – THE CHILDHOOD FRIEND

The title "THE CHILDHOOD FRIEND" is directly connected to the central idea of the story. At the beginning, the title simply identifies Venkat, the character introduced as Sanjay's friend from school. As the story unfolds, the title takes on a deeper meaning: it comes to represent the quiet, dependable nature of a bond formed early in life, one that does not need constant attention to remain strong.

By the end of the film, the audience understands that the title is not just a description of a character but a statement about the story's theme — that a childhood friendship, even when temporarily overshadowed by newer relationships, remains a source of genuine support when it truly matters.

CHAPTER 4
GENRE

The film belongs to the emotional drama and slice-of-life genre, set within a relatable college friendship context. Unlike a thriller, tension in this film is created not through danger but through small social cues — a hesitation, a missed invitation, a disappointed expression — that build quiet emotional discomfort.

The story's honesty is maintained by keeping the conflict realistic and low-key. The audience is never given exaggerated drama; instead, they recognise the situation from their own experience, which makes the eventual emotional payoff more effective.

The major emotional and narrative elements used in the film are:

- Casual, relatable college dialogue
- A subtle shift in attention from old friend to new friend
- A moment of visible disappointment
- An unexpected crisis (the missed bus)
- A test of true friendship
- Quiet loyalty from the overlooked friend
- A heartfelt realisation and apology
- A closing message that reinforces the film's theme

CHAPTER 5
OBJECTIVES

The main objective of the project is to create an engaging short emotional drama using basic film-making techniques and a simple production setup. The project also aims to demonstrate how camera work, lighting, editing and sound can be combined to create warmth, subtle tension and emotional payoff.

The specific objectives are:

- To develop an original short-film story around a relatable, everyday theme.
- To understand screenplay and scene development for dialogue-driven drama.
- To practice camera framing and shot composition for multi-character conversation scenes.
- To use lighting to establish a warm, familiar mood.
- To create emotional impact through editing, pacing and music rather than shock or suspense.
- To develop basic video editing skills.
- To understand the importance of background music and sound effects in guiding audience emotion.
- To adapt the story into a radio podcast format.
- To understand the difference between visual and audio storytelling.

CHAPTER 6
STORY DEVELOPMENT

The story was developed around the simple, universal idea that people sometimes unintentionally take old friends for granted once new friendships enter their lives. The initial concept was kept simple so that the emotional arc could be developed gradually, without requiring multiple locations or a large cast.

The first part establishes the three characters and their easy camaraderie. Venkat's entry and Sanjay's introduction of him as a childhood friend plant the emotional foundation of the story. The middle section, where all three bond over academics, allows the audience to see genuine friendship among all three before any conflict appears.

The final part was developed to build emotional tension step by step. First, Venkat is gently overlooked when Sanjay chooses to go with Jai instead. Then, Sanjay faces a real problem — missing his bus. Jai's unavailability and Venkat's immediate, unconditional support create the emotional turning point, leading naturally into Sanjay's apology and the story's closing reflection.

CHAPTER 7
STORY SYNOPSIS

The story follows Sanjay, a college student sitting in his room with his new college friend, Jai. The two casually discuss their semester marks and agree that they need to study more seriously. Their conversation is interrupted when Venkat, Sanjay's childhood friend, walks in.

Sanjay introduces Venkat and Jai to each other, and the three quickly get along. Sitting together, they talk about academics, assignments and the upcoming exam. Venkat suggests that studying together as a group would make things easier, and Jai agrees enthusiastically. All three happily agree to prepare together.

After some time, Venkat says he is hungry and suggests they go out to eat. Sanjay hesitates and asks him to wait. Moments later, Jai makes the same suggestion, and Sanjay agrees immediately, getting up to leave with him. Venkat points out that he had just asked the same thing, but Sanjay simply apologises and leaves with Jai, leaving Venkat visibly disappointed.

Shortly after, Sanjay checks his phone and realises he has missed his college bus. Jai is unable to help because he already has plans with another friend and leaves. Sanjay is left worried, with an important class ahead of him. Venkat steps forward without being asked and offers to drop him personally.

Surprised, Sanjay asks Venkat if he still wants to help him after being ignored earlier. Venkat brushes it off warmly, saying that friendship does not keep score of such things, and urges Sanjay to hurry since they are already late. Moved by this, Sanjay reflects that while new friends are welcome, the value of an old friend should never be forgotten. The film ends with the on-screen message: "A FRIEND IN NEED IS A FRIEND INDEED."

CHAPTER 8
CHARACTERS

Sanjay – The Common Friend

Sanjay is the central character of the film, connected to both Venkat and Jai. He is warm and easy-going, but his attention is unconsciously drawn toward his newer friendship with Jai over the course of the story. His arc is defined by a gradual realisation — he does not intend to hurt Venkat, but his casual choices reveal a shift in priority. His growth is completed when he acknowledges this and apologises, making him a relatable and sympathetic protagonist.

Venkat – The Childhood Friend

Venkat represents dependable, unconditional friendship. Introduced early as Sanjay's school-time best friend, he is affectionate and easy-going throughout the film, even when subtly sidelined. His willingness to help Sanjay without hesitation, despite being overlooked minutes earlier, is the emotional core of the story and the reason the title carries its full meaning by the end.

Jai – The New College Friend

Jai is friendly and genuinely likeable, and his presence is not framed as a rivalry or a villainous influence. He simply represents a newer, situational friendship — present and engaged when things are easy, but unavailable when a real need arises. His character is important precisely because he is not shown as unkind, which keeps the story's message honest rather than exaggerated.

CHAPTER 9
SCENE DEVELOPMENT

9.1 Scene 1 – Introduction (0:00–0:30)

The first scene establishes Sanjay and Jai sitting together, casually discussing their semester marks. This everyday, low-stakes conversation sets a relaxed tone before Venkat enters. When Venkat arrives, Sanjay introduces him to Jai as his childhood friend, and the two exchange a friendly greeting. The purpose of this scene is to establish all three relationships clearly and to create a warm, familiar atmosphere.

The camera can use medium shots to capture the group dynamic, with a slightly wider shot as Venkat enters to visually welcome him into the frame and the friendship.

9.2 Scene 2 – Friendship Talk (0:30–0:55)

All three characters sit together and talk about academics, assignments and the approaching exam. Venkat suggests studying as a group, and Jai agrees enthusiastically, with all three happily agreeing to prepare together. This scene is important because it shows genuine, uncomplicated friendship among all three before any tension is introduced.

A single medium shot holding all three characters in frame reinforces their closeness, making the contrast with the following scene more effective.

9.3 Scene 3 – Ignoring the Old Friend (0:55–1:20)

After some time, Venkat says he is hungry and asks Sanjay to go out and eat. Sanjay hesitates and asks him to wait. Moments later, Jai makes an identical suggestion, and Sanjay immediately agrees and gets up. Venkat points out that he asked the same thing first, but Sanjay only offers a quick apology before leaving with Jai.

This is the emotional turning point of the film. The camera can favour a close-up on Venkat's disappointed expression as Sanjay leaves, allowing the audience to register the quiet hurt without any exaggerated dialogue.

9.4 Scene 4 – The Real Friend (1:20–1:50)

Sanjay suddenly checks his phone and realises he has missed his college bus. Jai apologises but says he cannot help, as he is already leaving with another friend, and exits. Left worried about missing an important class, Sanjay is unsure what to do. Venkat then steps forward and offers to drop him personally.

Sanjay, surprised, asks if Venkat is still willing to help after being ignored earlier. Venkat brushes off the question warmly, saying that friendship does not keep track of such things, and urges Sanjay to hurry. A close-up on Sanjay's surprised, grateful expression captures the emotional shift, while the scene's pace should quicken slightly to reflect the urgency of the situation.

9.5 Scene 5 – Ending (1:50–2:00)

Sanjay smiles emotionally and reflects that while new friends may come along, the value of old friends must never be forgotten. Venkat smiles in response. The film closes on the on-screen text: "A FRIEND IN NEED IS A FRIEND INDEED," reinforcing the story's central message directly to the audience.

CHAPTER 10
CLIMAX AND ENDING

The climax occurs when Sanjay, having just overlooked Venkat in favour of Jai, finds himself in genuine need — and it is Venkat, not Jai, who steps up without hesitation. This reversal is the emotional heart of the film: the friend who was taken for granted becomes the one who proves most reliable.

The ending is resolved rather than left open-ended, which suits the film's reflective, message-driven tone. Sanjay's spoken realisation, followed by the on-screen text, gives the audience a clear, satisfying takeaway rather than ambiguity, making the film suitable for a short, values-driven piece.

CHAPTER 11
CINEMATOGRAPHY

Cinematography is used to guide the audience's attention across a story that unfolds mainly through dialogue and expression rather than action. During the early scenes, medium and wide shots capture the easy group dynamic among the three friends and establish the room as a comfortable, shared space.

As the emotional tension builds in Scene 3, closer shots become important — particularly reaction shots of Venkat's disappointment and Sanjay's hesitation. Over-the-shoulder framing between Sanjay and each friend can subtly reinforce who he is emotionally facing at any given moment. During the climax, slightly quicker cuts between Sanjay's worried expression and Venkat's calm offer of help can heighten the sense of urgency and relief.

CHAPTER 12
LIGHTING

Lighting plays a supporting role in establishing the film's warm, familiar tone throughout. Since the story takes place in a single, everyday room during the day, natural or soft indoor lighting can be used consistently to maintain a comfortable, realistic atmosphere.

During the emotional beats — particularly Venkat's disappointed expression in Scene 3 and Sanjay's grateful reaction in Scene 4 — lighting can be kept soft and slightly warmer on faces to draw attention to expression without shifting the overall mood into something heavier than the story calls for. The film does not require dramatic lighting changes, as its emotional shifts are carried by performance and editing rather than atmosphere.

CHAPTER 13
SOUND DESIGN

Sound design in THE CHILDHOOD FRIEND supports the film's grounded, everyday setting. Background elements such as a cricket match playing on the television establish the casual domestic environment from the very first shot and can continue at low volume through the early scenes.

As the emotional tension rises in Scene 3, the background sound can be gently lowered to draw focus toward the dialogue and Venkat's reaction. A subtle, understated emotional score can be introduced from the missed-bus moment onward, building gradually through Venkat's offer to help and resolving warmly during the final scene.

Important sound elements include:

- Television/cricket match ambience
- Casual room and conversation ambience
- Phone notification/vibration sound (missed bus)
- Footsteps and door movement
- A subtle rising emotional score from Scene 4
- Warm, resolving music under the closing message

CHAPTER 14
EDITING TECHNIQUES

Editing in this film is used primarily to manage pacing and emotional rhythm rather than to create suspense. Early scenes can use natural, unhurried cuts that let the group conversation breathe. A simple time-jump transition (as indicated by "After some time" in the script) can be used to move from the friendship-talk scene into the hunger/ignoring scene without needing a new location.

In Scene 3, editing can briefly hold on Venkat's face after Sanjay leaves, letting the disappointment register before cutting away. In Scene 4, slightly quicker cutting between Sanjay checking his phone, Jai's exit and Venkat's entrance can convey urgency. The final scene can slow down again, using a longer, steadier shot to let the emotional resolution land.

CHAPTER 15
USE OF PROPS AND LOCATION

The project is designed to be produced using a single, simple location and easily available props, keeping the production practical while allowing the focus to remain fully on the characters and their relationships.

The major props and location elements required are:

- One room with a bed, sofa and table/chairs
- Television (playing a cricket match)
- Mobile phone
- Pillow/cushions for the sofa seating
- Door (for exits and entrances)

CHAPTER 16
RADIO PODCAST ADAPTATION

The same story can be adapted into a radio podcast by removing the visual dependency and replacing visual information — particularly facial expressions and body language — with narration, tone of voice and sound effects.

In the short film, the audience can see Venkat's disappointed face as Sanjay leaves with Jai. In the podcast, the same emotion must be communicated through Venkat's voice — a slight change in tone, a pause before he speaks, or a quieter delivery of his line. Similarly, Sanjay's growing realisation and gratitude toward the end must be conveyed through vocal warmth and emotional pacing rather than a visible smile.

CHAPTER 17
RADIO PODCAST SCRIPT APPROACH

The podcast version can begin with a narrator briefly setting the scene — Sanjay and Jai talking in his room, with the sound of a cricket commentary playing faintly in the background. Their dialogue about semester marks can be presented naturally through voice acting.

When Venkat enters, a light footstep and door sound can cue his arrival before he speaks, and the narrator can briefly describe the introduction if needed for clarity. During the friendship-talk scene, voices can overlap naturally to suggest easy camaraderie.

In the ignoring scene, a brief narrated pause ("Sanjay hesitated") before his line to Venkat, followed immediately by an eager, unhesitating tone when responding to Jai, can convey the imbalance without extra explanation. Venkat's line pointing out the double standard should be delivered evenly, not angrily, to preserve his character's warmth.

For the missed-bus scene, a phone notification sound effect can mark the moment of realisation, followed by Jai's apologetic exit and Venkat's steady, reassuring offer to help. The closing lines can be delivered slowly and warmly, with gentle music rising underneath, before the narrator or a closing audio sting delivers the final message: "A friend in need is a friend indeed."

CHAPTER 18
VOICE AND AUDIO PERFORMANCE

Voice acting is especially important for the podcast version, as the audience depends entirely on sound to understand the emotional dynamics between the three friends.

Sanjay's voice should sound casual and relaxed at the start, shift to slightly hurried and dismissive during the ignoring scene, then become worried during the missed-bus moment, before settling into a warm, reflective tone at the end. Venkat's voice should remain consistently warm and easy-going, with only a brief, restrained dip in energy when he is overlooked — never bitter or sarcastic. Jai's voice should stay friendly and light throughout, including in his apologetic exit, so that he is never perceived as unkind.

The following elements are important:

- Clear, natural pronunciation of colloquial dialogue
- Appropriate pauses to convey hesitation or disappointment
- Emotional voice modulation across the three character arcs
- Distinct, consistent voices for each of the three characters
- Controlled speaking speed, quickening during the urgency of the missed-bus scene
- Warm, understated background music
- Effective use of brief silence after emotionally charged lines

CHAPTER 19
PRODUCTION PROCESS

The production of the project can be divided into three stages: pre-production, production and post-production.

During pre-production, the story idea was developed and converted into a screenplay with five clearly timed scenes. The characters, single location and required props were identified, and the emotional pacing — from casual friendship, through quiet neglect, to crisis and resolution — was planned in advance.

During production, the scenes were recorded according to the screenplay, with particular attention to capturing natural group chemistry in the early scenes and genuine reaction shots during the emotional turning points. Voice recordings for the podcast adaptation were also prepared alongside the visual shoot.

During post-production, the recorded footage was organised and edited according to the screenplay's timing. Background television sound, ambient room noise and a subtle emotional score were added, and the final video was exported after checking the complete sequence for pacing and emotional flow.

CHAPTER 20
CHALLENGES FACED

One of the major challenges in producing an emotional drama with a simple setup is conveying a meaningful shift in feeling using only subtle dialogue and expression, without the aid of dramatic effects or multiple locations. Since the story takes place in one room with everyday conversation, performance and timing had to carry nearly the entire emotional weight.

Another challenge was ensuring that Sanjay's neglect of Venkat felt natural and unintentional rather than exaggerated or unkind, so that his later realisation would feel earned rather than sudden. Similarly, Jai's character needed to remain likeable throughout, so the story would not read as a simple "good friend versus bad friend" comparison.

Audio and timing synchronisation was also important — background television sound, phone notifications and dialogue needed to occur at the correct moments to support, rather than distract from, the emotional beats of each scene.

CHAPTER 21
LEARNING OUTCOMES

Through this project, several practical skills can be developed. The project provides experience in screenplay writing, scene planning, camera operation, lighting, acting, sound recording and video editing, specifically within a dialogue-driven, character-focused format.

The project also demonstrates that emotional impact in storytelling does not require dramatic plot devices — a well-timed pause, a quiet reaction shot or a subtle change in vocal tone can communicate as much as an elaborate scene.

The radio podcast adaptation provides additional experience in voice acting, narration and audio editing, and demonstrates how the same story must be presented differently depending on the medium, particularly when the original relies heavily on visible facial expression.

CHAPTER 22
EXPECTED OUTCOME

The final outcome of the project is a short emotional drama film titled THE CHILDHOOD FRIEND, supported by a radio podcast adaptation of the same story. The film is expected to engage the audience through a relatable, everyday college scenario that gradually reveals a meaningful lesson about loyalty and friendship.

The project demonstrates the practical use of visual storytelling, sound design and editing techniques in service of an emotional, values-driven narrative. The clear, resolved ending allows the audience to walk away with a direct and memorable message, reinforced by the closing on-screen text.

CHAPTER 23
CONCLUSION

The THE CHILDHOOD FRIEND project demonstrates how a simple, everyday story can be developed into an engaging and emotionally resonant short film through effective use of film-making techniques. The story begins with an ordinary conversation between college friends and gradually reveals a meaningful conflict around loyalty, attention and the value of old friendships.

The project combines screenplay writing, acting, cinematography, lighting, sound design and video editing. Each element contributes to the story's emotional pacing, from its light opening to its warm, reflective conclusion. The use of a single location and a small cast also demonstrates that an effective short film does not necessarily require complex production resources.

The radio podcast adaptation further demonstrates how storytelling can be transferred from a visual medium to an audio medium. Elements that are visible in the film — particularly expressions of disappointment and gratitude — must be communicated through voice performance, sound effects, music and silence.

Overall, THE CHILDHOOD FRIEND provides practical experience in both film making and radio podcasting while demonstrating the importance of subtlety, timing and emotional honesty in media production.

"A friend in need is a friend indeed."